

Cosmic Signature

A Procedural On-Chain Art Protocol on Arbitrum

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Abstract

Cosmic Signature is a procedural art protocol on Arbitrum One. It runs as a sequence of timed Performance Cycles. During a cycle, participants make gestures with ETH or with CST, the protocol's ERC-20 token. Every gesture extends the cycle's countdown, records an entry in the cycle's Stellar Selections, and can imprint new CST. When the countdown expires and the cycle is finalized, the protocol distributes its ETH reserve across more than ten allocation tracks, imprints a new generation of Cosmic Signature NFTs, and forwards a fixed share to Protocol Guild, the funding mechanism for more than 170 Ethereum core contributors. About half of the reserve rolls forward, so each cycle begins larger than the last.

Each Cosmic Signature NFT is a deterministic rendering of the gravitational three-body problem, generated from an on-chain seed and reproducible by anyone, pixel for pixel. No neural network touches the image. This paper describes the mechanics and token design in full, documents the V2 upgrade that is live today, presents the planned V3 upgrade, and sets out the commitment to remove every form of privileged control from the deploying address once the design is complete.

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1. Introduction

Cosmic Signature began with two convictions. The first is that generative art is most interesting when nothing about it is arbitrary: when every image is the output of a physical process, fixed by a seed, and anyone can rerun that process to verify the result. The second is that a protocol

which holds ETH on behalf of its participants owes them a mechanical, readable answer to the question of where every wei goes.

The result is a protocol built around time. A Performance Cycle opens, fills with gestures, and closes when its countdown runs out. A gesture is a small on-chain act: it carries ETH or CST, it may carry a short message or an attached asset, and it pushes the cycle’s finalization time further into the future. The participant whose gesture stands last when the countdown expires, the Final Gesture, finalizes the cycle. Finalization distributes the reserve, imprints the cycle’s NFTs, and prepares the next cycle.

Three properties anchor the design.

- **Determinism.** The artwork is computed from a seed recorded on-chain at imprint time. The rendering pipeline is open source, and the same seed always produces the same image and video, bit for bit.
- **Mechanical distribution.** The deployed contracts execute the allocation rules at finalization. No discretionary account sits between participants and those rules, and no team wallet receives ETH from gestures.
- **A finite role for the team.** Owner powers are narrow, are locked while a cycle runs, and are scheduled to be removed entirely once the remaining upgrades land.

This paper is the reference description of the protocol. Section 2 sketches the system. Sections 3 through 5 specify cycles, gestures, and allocations. Section 6 covers the art. Sections 7 through 10 cover CST, anchoring, the Cosmic Council, and Public Goods. Section 11 covers security and verifiability. Sections 12 and 13 record the upgrade history and the road to full decentralization, and Section 14 states plainly what the protocol is not. Numbers quoted in this paper are contract constants or launch values of on-chain parameters; the deployed contracts, listed in Appendix A, remain the final authority.

2. Protocol overview

The system consists of one core contract and a ring of narrow, single-purpose contracts around it. The core, deployed behind an upgradeable proxy, runs the cycles: it prices gestures, tracks the countdown, holds the Cycle Reserve, and executes finalization. Around it sit the CST token, the Cosmic Signature NFT collection, an escrow wallet for allocations, two anchoring wallets, the Public Goods Vault, the Outreach Reserve, and the Cosmic Council.

Component	Role
Protocol contract	Runs Performance Cycles: gesture pricing, the countdown, the Cycle Reserve, and finalization.
CST (ERC-20)	Participation token. Imprinted only by the protocol, burned when spent on gestures, and expresses Coordination Weight once delegated.
Cosmic Signature NFT (ERC-721)	Deterministic three-body artwork. Imprinted only at finalization, with its seed stored on-chain.
Random Walk NFT	An earlier generative collection from the same team. Grants a one-time Gesture Cost reduction and a separate anchored Selection track.
Allocations Wallet	Escrow for secondary ETH allocations and assets attached to gestures, with an open retrieval timeout.

Component	Role
Anchoring wallets	One for Cosmic Signature NFTs (ETH Anchor Distributions) and one for Random Walk NFTs (Selection eligibility).
Public Goods Vault	Receives and forwards the per-cycle Public Goods Allocation. The beneficiary is currently Protocol Guild.
Outreach Reserve	Receives 3,000 CST per cycle for community outreach.
Cosmic Council	On-chain coordination body in which delegated CST expresses Coordination Weight.

Around the contracts, an ecosystem has grown: the app at app.cosmicsignature.com, the Axiom Zero marketplace for the NFTs, Uniswap liquidity for CST on Arbitrum, and Chaos Zero, a prediction venue for cycle outcomes. None of these are required. Every mechanic in this paper can be exercised directly against the contracts.

3. The Performance Cycle

A cycle is a window in time. It opens with descending-cost Calibration Windows, fills with gestures, and ends when the Cycle Finalization Time expires and someone finalizes it. This section covers the clock; Section 4 covers the gestures themselves.

3.1 Opening and the ETH Calibration Window

Each cycle must open with an ETH gesture, and the ETH Calibration Window sets its cost. The window begins at 2 times the opening cost actually paid in the previous cycle and declines linearly to a floor of one two-hundredth of that starting value, plus one wei. At launch parameters the descent takes about two days; its duration is tied to the cycle time increment, so it stretches slowly as the protocol ages. If the window fully elapses before anyone gestures, the cost simply rests at the floor. The first cycle opened at a fixed 0.0001 ETH.

This opening mechanism performs price discovery without an order book. If the previous cycle opened too cheap, the doubling restores headroom; if the doubled value proves too high, the two-day descent finds the level at which someone is willing to begin.

3.2 The countdown

The opening gesture starts the clock, setting the Cycle Finalization Time about 24 hours ahead at launch parameters. Every subsequent gesture, whether ETH or CST, adds the current time increment to the stored finalization time. The increment began at exactly one hour and grows by 1% with every finalized cycle, so cycles lengthen gradually and the pace of NFT imprinting slows over the years. There is no hard bound on a cycle's length while gestures keep arriving; in practice, rising Gesture Costs make indefinite extension expensive.

Extensions apply to the stored time, not to the present moment. A gesture made after the countdown has expired, but before finalization executes, adds one increment to the stored value and takes over the Final Gesture position. It does not restart the clock.

3.3 Finalization and the Open-Finalization Window

When the Cycle Finalization Time expires, the participant who made the Final Gesture becomes eligible to finalize. Finalization is one transaction: it reads the protocol's ETH balance, distributes the allocation tracks of Section 5, imprints the cycle's NFTs and CST, records the seed for each new artwork, and schedules the next cycle.

The Final Gesture participant holds this right exclusively for 48 hours. After that, the Open-Finalization Window begins: anyone may finalize, and the contract treats whoever does as the cycle's beneficiary, with everything the role carries: the Signature Allocation's ETH share, its CST imprint, its NFT, and priority over attached assets. The rule is deliberately unforgiving. It keeps the protocol alive if a participant disappears, and it prices carelessness: a beneficiary who does not act within two days has left the role open to the first caller.

After finalization, the next cycle activates following a short delay, 30 minutes by default, and its Calibration Windows open.

4. Gestures

Gestures drive each Performance Cycle. Each one, regardless of currency, extends the countdown, records one entry in the cycle's participant Stellar Selections, updates the endurance clocks of Section 5.2, and can imprint Participation CST as described in Section 7.1.

4.1 ETH gestures

After the opening gesture, each ETH gesture raises the next ETH Gesture Cost by 1%, plus one wei. The sequence is public and exact: anyone can read the current cost from the contract before acting. Overpayment above a dust threshold is refunded in the same transaction; below that threshold a refund would cost more in gas than it returns, so the difference stays in the reserve.

4.2 Random Walk NFT attachment

A participant who owns a Random Walk NFT may attach it to one ETH gesture for a 50% reduction in that gesture's cost. The NFT is not transferred; the contract marks it used. Each Random Walk NFT can be attached exactly once across all cycles, which makes the reduction a consumable resource and ties a fixed external collection into the protocol's economy.

4.3 CST gestures

CST offers a second way in. The CST Calibration Window starts at 2 times the cost paid for the previous CST gesture, and never below 200 CST, then declines linearly to zero over the window's duration. Every CST gesture restarts the window from its new starting value, and the CST spent is burned, permanently removed from supply.

The window's duration is itself a live parameter, and it is one of the protocol's quieter feedback loops. It began at a 12-hour reference. Each ETH gesture shortens it by about 0.398%, and each CST gesture lengthens it by about 0.4%. Heavy ETH activity therefore speeds the CST

descent, making CST gestures attractive sooner; heavy CST activity slows it back down. The loop nudges every cycle toward a balanced mix of the two currencies.

Because the descent can reach zero, a long quiet period can make a CST gesture nearly free. That is intentional. It guarantees the cycle can always be extended by anyone holding even a small CST balance, and the burn on every CST gesture ties the token's supply to actual use. A participant submitting a CST gesture specifies the maximum cost they accept, so a gesture landing later than expected cannot spend more than authorized.

The first gesture of every cycle must be ETH; CST gestures are available from the second gesture onward.

4.4 Messages and attached assets

A gesture may carry a message of up to 280 bytes, recorded on-chain alongside it. A gesture may also attach ERC-20 tokens or an ERC-721 NFT. Attached assets do not join the ETH reserve; they are held by the Allocations Wallet, and the cycle's beneficiary has priority to retrieve them after finalization, subject to the open retrieval timeout of Section 5.4.

5. The Cycle Reserve and allocation tracks

All ETH paid for gestures accumulates in the protocol contract, together with roughly half of every previous cycle's reserve. This balance is the Cycle Reserve. Finalization reads it once and distributes fixed percentages of it.

5.1 Distribution at finalization

ETH track	Share of Cycle Reserve	Recipient
Signature Allocation	25%	The cycle beneficiary, normally the Final Gesture participant.
Chrono-Warrior Allocation	8%	The longest-reigning Endurance Champion (Section 5.2).
ETH Stellar Selection	4%	3 entries selected from the cycle's gesture pool, sharing the amount equally.
Anchor Distribution	6%	Anchored Cosmic Signature NFTs, pro rata.
Public Goods Allocation	7%	Protocol Guild, via the Public Goods Vault.
Compounding Cycle Reserve	~50% (the remainder)	Rolls forward into the next cycle.

Percentages are read against the protocol's ETH balance at the moment of finalization.

The five distributed tracks account for about half of the reserve. The remainder carries forward into the next cycle. Its size depends on the ETH added and distributed; a larger reserve is not guaranteed each cycle. If no Cosmic Signature NFTs are anchored at finalization, the Anchor Distribution is skipped and its share also remains in the Cycle Reserve.

CST and NFT track	Distribution	Recipient
Signature Allocation	1,000 CST and one NFT	The cycle beneficiary.
Chrono-Warrior	1,000 CST and one NFT	The Chrono-Warrior.
Endurance Champion	1,000 CST and one NFT	The Endurance Champion.
Final CST Gesture	1,000 CST and one NFT	The participant who made the cycle's last CST gesture.
NFT Stellar Selection	1,000 CST and one NFT, 10 times	10 entries selected from the gesture pool.
Anchored-NFT Stellar Selection	1,000 CST and one NFT, 10 times	10 selections across anchored Random Walk NFTs.
Outreach Reserve	3,000 CST	Community outreach (Section 7.1).

A typical cycle therefore imprints 24 Cosmic Signature NFTs and 27,000 CST in fixed distributions, plus whatever Participation CST individual gestures imprinted along the way. Cycles with no CST gestures skip the Final CST Gesture track; cycles with no anchored Random Walk NFTs skip the anchored Selection.

5.2 Endurance Champion and Chrono-Warrior

Two tracks measure persistence rather than position. The Endurance Champion is the participant who remained the most recent gesture maker for the longest unbroken interval during the cycle: the longest quiet gap that a single gesture survived. The Chrono-Warrior sits one level up: the participant who held the Endurance Champion title itself for the longest unbroken interval.

The distinction is subtle but real. A participant who gestures during a slow afternoon and is not displaced for ten hours sets a strong endurance interval. Whether they end the cycle as its Chrono-Warrior depends on how long that record stands before another participant surpasses it. Endurance measures the gap you created; the Chrono track measures how long your record survived. Both resolve only at finalization.

5.3 Stellar Selections

Each gesture records one entry in the cycle's participant Selection pool. At finalization, the contract selects 3 entries for the ETH Stellar Selection, which share 4% of the reserve equally, and 10 entries for the NFT Stellar Selection. Selections are made with replacement, so the same participant can be selected more than once, and entries scale with gestures made: selection frequency is proportional to participation.

A separate Anchored-NFT Stellar Selection runs across anchored Random Walk NFTs: 10 selections, weighted by the number of NFTs each holder has anchored. This track distributes CST and Cosmic Signature NFTs only; it carries no ETH.

The randomness behind these selections is constructed on-chain at finalization. Section 11.3 describes its sources and its limits.

5.4 Delivery, escrow, and timeouts

Distribution is deliberately split between push and pull. The Signature Allocation's ETH goes directly to the beneficiary during finalization, as does the Public Goods forwarding. The Chrono-

Warrior’s ETH and the ETH Selection shares are placed in the Allocations Wallet, an escrow contract, from which each recipient retrieves at their convenience. CST and NFTs are imprinted directly to their recipients during finalization.

Escrowed allocations and attached assets wait 5 weeks. After that, the contracts permit anyone to retrieve an unretrieved allocation for themselves. The rule mirrors the Open-Finalization Window: nothing in the protocol waits forever on an absent participant, and every distribution eventually reaches a hand that wants it. Retrieve promptly.

6. The art: Deterministic three-body Signatures

Every Cosmic Signature NFT is a rendering of the gravitational three-body problem: three celestial bodies of comparable mass orbiting under Newtonian gravity. The three-body problem has no general closed-form solution, and its trajectories are chaotic; an imperceptible change in starting conditions produces a completely different dance. That chaos is the collection’s engine. The seed decides the starting conditions, physics does the rest, and no two Signatures repeat.

No generative model is involved at any stage. There is no training data, no sampling, and no prompt. The pipeline is a physics simulation followed by a renderer, written in Rust, published as open source, and fully deterministic.

6.1 The pipeline

- Seed. At imprint time the contract derives a 32-byte seed from on-chain data (Section 11.3) and stores it with the NFT. The seed initializes a SHA3-256 random number generator; everything downstream is a pure function of it.
- Simulation. One hundred thousand candidate configurations are integrated for one million physics steps each, using a fourth-order Yoshida symplectic integrator, which preserves the system’s energy behavior over long horizons.
- Selection. A Borda rank aggregation scores candidates on chaos and on the equilaterality of the triangle the bodies form, then picks the most visually interesting orbit from the pool.
- Camera. A slow elliptical camera drift moves the viewpoint through the orbit, giving each Signature a cinematic parallax.
- Color. Colors are mixed in the OKLab perceptual space with 120-degree hue separation per body, modulated by drift and a sine wave.
- Spectral rendering. Sixty-four wavelength bins spanning 380 to 700 nanometers render the orbit trails with velocity-dependent thickness and depth of field.
- Finishing. AgX tonemapping, bloom, OpenSimplex nebula layers, and color grading complete the frame.

The output for every NFT is a 16-bit PNG and a 30-second H.265 video.

6.2 Reproducibility and license

Determinism is enforced, not assumed. The same seed produces the same image, pixel for pixel, on any machine, and SHA-256 hashes of generated frames are asserted in continuous integration. Because every seed is stored on-chain and the pipeline is public, the collection does not depend

on any server. If every server disappeared tomorrow, every Signature could be regenerated from the chain.

Owners may name their NFTs on-chain, up to 32 bytes. Project-owned contracts, shaders, and rendering pipelines are dedicated under CC0 1.0, with no rights reserved; third-party dependencies retain their own licenses.

7. The CST token

CST is the protocol’s ERC-20 token. Its supply starts at zero, and the token contract accepts imprint and burn instructions only from the protocol contract. Every CST in circulation traces back to participation in a cycle.

7.1 Imprint rules

CST enters circulation through three flows. Participation CST is imprinted at gesture time by the formula below. Recognition CST is imprinted at finalization: 1,000 CST accompanies each of the cycle’s NFT distributions, 24 in a typical cycle. Finally, 3,000 CST per cycle goes to the Outreach Reserve, which the team uses for community outreach; it is the only recurring CST flow the team directs, and it carries no special powers.

$$\text{CST} = \left\lfloor \sqrt{\Delta t \times m \div i} \right\rfloor$$

Δt seconds since the previous gesture

m the Participation CST multiplier, a contract parameter

i the current cycle time increment, in microseconds

The expression in the contract

```
floor(sqrt(elapsedSinceLastGesture * bidCstRewardAmountMultiplier
/ mainPrizeTimeIncrementInMicroSeconds))
```

Participation CST imprinted by a gesture. Elapsed time is measured since the previous gesture and scaled against the current cycle time increment.

In plain terms, the amount grows with the square root of the time since the previous gesture. A gesture arriving one second after the last imprints almost nothing; a gesture that ends a day of silence imprints hundreds of CST.

Time since previous gesture	Participation CST
0 seconds	0
1 second	1.73
60 seconds	13.4
1 hour	104
1 day	509

Computed at the launch time increment of exactly 1 hour. Amounts drift slightly lower as the increment grows; the live app preview and the contract are the source of truth.

7.2 Burning and supply dynamics

CST leaves circulation whenever it is spent: the full cost of every CST gesture is burned. Supply is therefore shaped by behavior. Quiet cycles imprint little Participation CST, active CST usage burns supply back down, and the fixed Recognition and Outreach flows add 27,000 CST per typical cycle. Supply started at zero and has no hard cap. The recurring team-directed CST flow is the Outreach Reserve described in Section 7.1.

The square-root formula limits Participation CST and was introduced in the V2 upgrade (Section 12.2). The original design imprinted a flat 100 CST per gesture. Under the current rule, rapid successive gestures imprint little or no Participation CST, while longer intervals produce larger amounts. Recognition CST and the Outreach Reserve remain separate sources of supply.

7.3 Coordination Weight

CST doubles as the weight token of the Cosmic Council (Section 9). Weight activates on delegation: a holder delegates to themselves or to another address, and each CST then expresses one unit of Coordination Weight. The token uses timestamp-based checkpoints, so proposal snapshots refer to wall-clock time rather than block numbers.

8. Anchoring

Anchoring is the protocol’s form of long-term alignment. An owner may anchor a Cosmic Signature NFT to the protocol; while it is anchored, it accrues a proportional share of each cycle’s 6% Anchor Distribution. The accrued ETH is retrieved when the anchor is released. There is no fixed term and no penalty, but anchoring is a once-per-NFT decision: each NFT can be anchored only once, ever, so releasing it permanently ends that NFT’s anchoring eligibility.

The once-ever rule replaces the usual lock-up schedule with a single irreversible choice, and it gives the anchored set a real cost of exit. Whether to keep an NFT anchored is a live decision every cycle; whether to release it is a permanent one.

Random Walk NFTs anchor separately and for a different purpose: anchored Random Walk NFTs take part in the Anchored-NFT Stellar Selection (Section 5.3), 10 per cycle, each carrying 1,000 CST and a Cosmic Signature NFT. Random Walk anchoring carries no ETH distributions. The same once-ever rule applies.

9. The Cosmic Council

The Cosmic Council is the protocol’s on-chain coordination body, built on the audited Open-Zeppelin Governor framework with CST as its weight token. Any address holding at least 100 CST of delegated weight may submit a Coordination Proposal. Proposals wait through a 2-day coordination delay, then remain open for a 2-week coordination period.

A proposal passes when two conditions hold: Support exceeds Opposition, and Support plus Abstain weight reaches the Coordination Quorum of 3% of total CST supply. Opposition weight does not count toward the quorum. Expressing weight is a cryptographic act, not a share or an equity instrument, and delegation can be changed at any time.

Today the Council coordinates alongside the team’s scoped owner role. After the decentralization step of Section 13, it is the only coordination layer the protocol has.

10. Public Goods

Every cycle forwards 7% of the Cycle Reserve to the Public Goods Vault, whose beneficiary is currently Protocol Guild, the collective funding mechanism for more than 170 Ethereum core protocol contributors. The forwarding is enforced on-chain as part of finalization; no one decides each cycle whether to honor it. The more the protocol is used, the more flows to the infrastructure Ethereum itself depends on.

The reasoning is simple. Cosmic Signature exists because Ethereum’s base layer keeps working, and a protocol that lives on public infrastructure should fund it the way it does everything else: mechanically, on a schedule, in public. The vault also accepts voluntary ETH contributions directly, outside any cycle.

This is a forwarding of ETH to a public-goods address, currently Protocol Guild. It is not a charitable contribution or a donation in the U.S. tax sense, and Cosmic Signature makes no representation about its tax treatment in any jurisdiction.

11. Security, randomness, and verifiability

11.1 Independent review

In late 2025, Hacken carried out an independent security review of the Cosmic Signature contracts, covering the core protocol, the CST token, both NFT integrations, the anchoring wallets, and the supporting wallet and system-management contracts. The final report, published in January 2026, lists 23 findings: none critical, none high severity, 3 medium, 8 low, and 12 informational, most of them design trade-offs reviewed and accepted with written rationale.

Alongside the manual review, Hacken fuzz-tested 14 system invariants, properties such as the protocol’s ETH balance always equaling deposits minus distributions. All 14 held across 10,000 runs. The full report is public and linked in the references.

Beyond external review, the repository carries Certora formal verification specifications, Solidity SMTChecker configuration, Slither static analysis, and a test suite that targets complete coverage of the Solidity sources.

11.2 Defensive design

- Reentrancy guards protect every external entry point of the core contract.
- Pull over push: secondary ETH allocations and attached assets sit in escrow rather than being sent during finalization, so no recipient contract can block a cycle from closing.
- Failure-tolerant forwarding: if the Public Goods transfer cannot complete, finalization proceeds anyway and the event is recorded for later handling.
- Inter-cycle locks: core parameter changes and contract upgrades are impossible while a cycle is running (Section 13).

11.3 Randomness

The protocol needs randomness twice: for the Stellar Selections at finalization and for each new NFT’s seed. It builds a seed on-chain by folding together the previous block hash, the current base fee, and Arbitrum-specific entropy from the ArbSys and ArbGasInfo precompiles: the previous Arbitrum block hash, the gas backlog, and L1 pricing counters. Individual values are then derived from that seed with keccak256. The precompile calls are failure-tolerant; if one is unavailable, the construction falls back to the remaining sources.

This is deliberate minimalism: no oracle, no external committee, no callback that could strand a cycle. The trade-off is stated plainly. A sequencer could in principle influence block-level inputs, and the design bounds what that influence could reach. Stellar Selections and art seeds are the only consumers of randomness; the countdown, the Gesture Cost sequence, and every percentage in Section 5 are deterministic. The construction is consumed once per finalization, and finalization is a public transaction anyone can submit.

11.4 Open verification

All contracts are source-verified with exact-match status on Sourcify for Arbitrum One (chain 42161), at the addresses fixed in Appendix A. The art pipeline’s determinism is asserted in continuous integration with SHA-256 hashes of rendered frames. Project-owned code is CC0: anyone may fork the contracts, the renderer, or the site, and anyone can check any Signature by regenerating it from its seed.

12. Deployment history and the road ahead

Cosmic Signature is designed to be finished. Upgradability exists so the mechanics can be corrected against observed behavior during the protocol’s early life, and it ends when the design does. This section records what has shipped and what remains.

12.1 V1: Launch

V1 launched the protocol on Arbitrum One behind a UUPS upgradeable proxy: cycles, gestures, the allocation tracks, anchoring, the Council, and the art pipeline, essentially as described in this paper. Upgrades require the owner and are only possible between cycles. There is deliberately no mechanism for changing the contract mid-cycle, whatever the circumstances.

12.2 The V2 upgrade, live today

V2 is the implementation deployed today. It made five changes, each a response to observed or anticipated behavior.

- Dynamic Participation CST. The flat 100 CST per gesture became the square-root formula of Section 7.1. Flat imprinting turned rapid gesture sequences into free CST; the new rule imprints by patience, not by frequency.
- Minimum-imprint guards. Every gesture method gained a parameter for the smallest Participation CST amount the participant will accept, protecting them from timing shifts between signing and execution.

- A living CST Calibration Window. The window’s duration became a stored value that responds to the gesture mix (Section 4.3), so the ETH and CST paths keep each other in balance.
- A longer exclusivity window. The Final Gesture participant’s exclusive finalization window grew from 24 to 48 hours.
- Timing and arithmetic hardening. Countdown extensions now always apply to the stored finalization time, closing a loophole in which near-free CST gestures made after expiry could repeatedly push the deadline outward. The arithmetic that schedules the next cycle was also hardened so that no parameter configuration, however extreme, can prevent a cycle from finalizing.

12.3 The planned V3 upgrade

V3, currently in development in the public repository, changes exactly one thing: the cost of acting late. During the final 20 minutes before the Cycle Finalization Time, every Gesture Cost, whether ETH, ETH with a Random Walk NFT, or CST, is multiplied by a premium that ramps polynomially from 1x to 10x, reaching 10x at the deadline and staying there for any gesture made during overtime.

$m(t) = 1 + 9 \cdot (t / T)^8$, where $T = 20$ minutes

Late-cycle cost premium, with t the time elapsed within the final 20-minute window.

The exponent matters. Because the ramp is eighth-order, the premium is nearly invisible for most of the window and steep only at the very end: about 1.04x ten minutes before the deadline, about 1.9x at five minutes, about 7x at one minute, and 10x at zero.

The intent is to change the endgame. Under V2, waiting until the last seconds to gesture is nearly free, so a cycle can end in a flurry of low-signal timing moves. Under V3, a last-moment gesture is an expensive statement, sustained participation through the cycle is comparatively cheap, and the endurance tracks of Section 5.2 become much harder to ambush. Exact parameters may still be tuned before deployment; the mechanism is as described.

13. The path to full decentralization

The protocol currently has an owner: the address that deployed it. The role is real, and this paper does not minimize it. It is also narrow by construction and temporary by commitment.

While a cycle is running, the core parameters are locked. The owner cannot change percentages, increments, or costs mid-cycle, and cannot upgrade the contract; owner actions live in the gap between cycles. Three narrower controls remain available at any time: postponing an upcoming cycle’s activation, though only until its first gesture arrives; adjusting the delay before the next cycle; and managing peripheral contracts, meaning the Public Goods Vault’s beneficiary, NFT metadata URIs, and the escrow retrieval timeout. No owner power reaches escrowed allocations, imprinted NFTs, recorded seeds, or anyone’s CST balance, and no team wallet receives ETH from gestures.

These powers exist because the mechanism is novel. V2 exists because live behavior taught lessons no simulation would have caught, and V3 exists for the same reason. A bounded, public adjustment period is how the design gets finished. The strongest power in the list is the upgrade

itself, and even it is public: a new implementation is visible and verifiable on-chain before the next cycle begins.

It ends as follows. Once the remaining upgrades are complete, beginning with V3, and the mechanics and token design are judged final, privileged control will be removed from the deploying address entirely. The owner role will leave the deployer permanently, either by transfer to the Cosmic Council or by outright renouncement, with the exact mechanism announced in advance. From that point, no private party can upgrade the protocol or change its parameters, and the deploying address holds nothing that any other address does not. What remains is the protocol as deployed, the Council as its coordination layer, and the art.

Every step of this process is publicly visible on-chain, including the last one.

14. Clarifications and risk factors

14.1 What Cosmic Signature is not

Cosmic Signature is not a lottery, a casino, or a gambling product. There is no house, no dealer, and no bet. Participants exchange value for participation itself: every gesture is an expressive act that shapes the artwork, extends the cycle, and is recorded permanently on-chain. The protocol retains no operator's margin of any kind; every allocation track in Section 5 flows to participants, to anchored NFTs, to the compounding reserve, or to public goods.

Cosmic Signature is not an investment product, and nothing in this paper is investment advice or an offer of securities. CST and Cosmic Signature NFTs are participation and art objects. The protocol makes no promises about their price, liquidity, or future value, and no one should acquire them with an expectation of profit from the efforts of others.

14.2 Risk factors

- Smart contract risk. The contracts are reviewed, formally analyzed, and source-verified, and none of that is a guarantee. Unknown defects can exist in any software that holds value.
- Randomness limits. Stellar Selections use block-derived entropy (Section 11.3). A sequencer could in principle influence it; the design bounds the consequences but cannot eliminate them.
- Timing responsibilities. The 48-hour finalization window and the 5-week escrow timeout are real deadlines. Allocations left unretrieved past them become available to others, by design.
- Parameter changes. Until the decentralization step completes, parameters can change between cycles as described in Section 13. Every change is public before the next cycle begins.
- Asset volatility. The values of ETH, CST, and NFTs move. Participation costs real money; treat gestures as expenditure on participation and art, not as a path to financial gain.
- Regulatory uncertainty. The legal treatment of digital assets varies by jurisdiction and continues to evolve.

15. Conclusion

Cosmic Signature is an attempt to build a generative art protocol that needs no one’s permission and, eventually, no one’s stewardship. The mechanics are small enough to specify completely: descending-cost windows, a countdown that gestures extend, fixed allocation percentages, a compounding reserve, and art that is a pure function of physics and a seed. The upgrades that remain are few and public. When they are done, the owner role goes away, and what is left is what this paper describes: a clock, a reserve, a token, a council, and an unbroken series of Signatures, each one the record of the hands that shaped it.

Appendix A: Verified contract addresses

Contract	Address (Arbitrum One)
Protocol contract (proxy)	0x6a714Ae7B5b6eA520F6BCA23d2E609C4Fd5863F2
Protocol implementation (V2)	0x50eB3d05d2C463949DE9238D419385594f7AdB97
CST token	0xAD91843e6A58Ba560F577E676986AFb1dba6FBA0
Cosmic Signature NFT	0xbb84Be3500A63581d3F2d5AC3bdF8685AAedad25
Random Walk NFT	0x895a6F444BE4ba9d124F61DF736605792B35D66b
Cosmic Council	0xF3D52E1c681949be7E624778dB13DaD7F8c729db
Public Goods Vault	0x96bB0ADB414d5350f435E52f94946B6C7A0760a9
Outreach Reserve	0xa3802c799f5e3D3D3562A9B513a41C6aAF92e25e
Allocations Wallet	0xE1b619e9B39ea4109D2F429Ea5eAA307759b0011
Anchoring Wallet, Cosmic Signature NFTs	0x6308A405B4FF1eA890870Efe2a6D036750B81F7C
Anchoring Wallet, Random Walk NFTs	0x5EB3396092841E6c5b0b51141699F6711E830529

All contracts are exact-match verified on Sourcify for chain 42161. The proxy address is the protocol’s permanent address; implementations change only through the public upgrade process described in Sections 12 and 13.

Appendix B: Parameters at a glance

Parameter	Value
Opening cost, first cycle	0.0001 ETH (fixed)
ETH Calibration Window ceiling	2x the previous cycle’s opening cost paid
ETH Calibration Window floor	ceiling / 200, plus one wei
ETH Gesture Cost step-up	1% per ETH gesture, plus one wei
Random Walk NFT reduction	50%, once ever per NFT
CST Calibration Window ceiling	max(2x last CST cost paid, 200 CST)
CST Calibration Window floor	0 CST
CST Calibration Window duration	12-hour initial reference; about -0.398% per ETH gesture, +0.4% per CST gesture

Parameter	Value
Initial countdown after opening gesture	about 24 hours at launch
Time increment per gesture	1 hour at launch, growing 1% per cycle
Finalization exclusivity window	48 hours
Escrow retrieval timeout	5 weeks, then open retrieval
Gesture message limit	280 bytes
ETH allocation tracks	25% Signature, 8% Chrono-Warrior, 7% Public Goods, 6% Anchor Distribution, 4% ETH Stellar Selection
Compounding Cycle Reserve	about 50% rolls forward
Recognition CST per NFT distribution	1,000 CST
Outreach Reserve per cycle	3,000 CST
Typical imprints per cycle	24 NFTs, 27,000 fixed CST
Council parameters	100 CST proposal threshold, 2-day delay, 2-week period, 3% quorum
Delay before next cycle	30 minutes by default, owner-adjustable

Launch values are shown where a parameter evolves or is adjustable; the contracts report live values.

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